

The `strcspn()` is a part of the C standard library, it is defined in the `<string.h>` header file in C. The `strcspn` function is used to find the number of characters in the given string before the 1st occurrence of a character from the defined set of characters or string.

Syntax of `strcspn()`

```
strcspn(const char *str1, const char *str2)
```

where,

str1 : The Target string in which search has to be made.

str2 : Argument string containing characters to match in target string.

Return Value

This function returns the number of characters in the first string before the 1st occurrence of character present in second string.

Examples of `strcspn()`

These C programs demonstrate the use of `strcspn()` for various scenarios.
Using `strcspn()` to find characters before matching Character

```
#include <stdio.h>
```

```
#include <string.h>
```

```
â\200\213
```

```
int main()
```

```
{
```

```
â\200\213
```

```
    int size;
```

```
â\200\213
```

```
    // initializing strings
```

```
    char str1[] = "geeksforgeeks";
```

```
    char str2[] = "kfc";
```

```
â\200\213
```

```
    // using strcspn() to calculate initial chars
```

```
    // before 1st matching chars.
```

```
    size = strcspn(str1, str2);
```

```
    printf("str1: %s\n", str1);
```

```
    printf("str2: %s\n", str2);
```

```
    printf("The number of characters in str1 before \nfirst matched character from str2: %d\n", size);
```

```
}
```

Output

```
str1: geeksforgeeks
```

```
str2: kfc
```

```
The number of characters in str1 before  
first matched character from str2: 3
```